

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Applicant Type

Employed - Self-Employed - Student - Retired - Hosted/Sponsored

Every applicant needs

- Valid passport or travel document, plus any previous passports showing travel history
- Application confirmation and, if applicable, your biometric appointment confirmation
- Evidence of your travel plans - flight itinerary and accommodation booking or invitation, where available
- Financial evidence covering the trip (see the Financial Requirements Overview)

If you're employed

- A letter from your employer confirming your role, salary, length of employment, and approved leave dates for the trip
- Recent pay stubs (typically the last 3-6 months)
- Bank statements showing regular income and available balance

If you're self-employed or run a business

- Business registration documents
- Recent business and/or personal bank statements
- An accountant's letter or tax assessment summary, if available

If you're a student

- A current enrolment/study confirmation letter from your institution
- If a parent/guardian is funding the trip: their financial evidence and a letter confirming support and relationship

If you're retired

- Pension or retirement account statements
- Proof of property ownership, if applicable

If you're being hosted or sponsored

LETTER OF INVITATION

A Letter of Invitation from whoever is hosting or funding you in Canada isn't strictly mandatory for every application, but it's strong supporting evidence - include it along with the host's own status and financial evidence where relevant. See the Cover Letter & Sponsor Letter Templates (Complete tier).